

Multiple Syllabuses Syllabus Support

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Ancient History 11–12 (2024)

Teaching advice for Stage 6

Teaching advice for Investigating ancient history – The nature of ancient history and Case studies

Content

- Investigating ancient history – The nature of ancient history
- Investigating ancient history – Case studies

Teaching advice

This teaching advice applies to the 2 Investigating ancient history focus areas and is applicable for all options.

The Investigating ancient history focus area consists of 2 parts. The nature of ancient history introduces students to the methods and issues of constructing history. Students then apply this understanding in the Case studies.

Students develop targeted historical skills including the analysis and use of sources, historical interpretation, explanation and communication. Using the discipline-based process of historical inquiry, students analyse sources for evidence, which they then use to develop claims about the past, considering key concepts such as perspectives and contestability. Using these reasoned claims, students explain and communicate their understanding through historical accounts and arguments.

Selecting one case study from each of List A and List B allows students to develop and apply historical skills to a diverse range of ancient societies, historical events and personalities. Consider students' backgrounds, interests and access to source material when selecting case study options.

Designing teaching and learning

Integrating historical concepts and skills

Historical concepts provide the framework through which students develop their understanding of the complexities of the past and the way it has been interpreted through time. They allow students to engage with historical thinking and form their own increasingly perceptive interpretations of historical events, ideas and forces. Teachers select the appropriate concepts on which to focus that align closely with their chosen content options. Some concepts will lend themselves more readily to specific options than others.

Use of sources

Sources are the key to any inquiry into the past and form the basis for historical analysis and interpretation. Using sources, students engage with a variety of perspectives as evidence to inform their understanding of the past. When selecting sources for teaching and learning activities, teachers should use and model ethical practices, such as the consideration of copyright and intellectual property acknowledgement, heritage issues, and Indigenous Cultural and Intellectual Property (ICIP) concerns, to ensure students understand the importance of engaging appropriately when using historical source material. Select source material carefully to cater for the needs of the students in the class, considering accessibility needs and issues such as the availability of audio

and/or closed captions with videos, and of other materials such as tactile objects and replicas of maps and artefacts.

Historical inquiry

Historical inquiry is an active process that allows students to develop and enact the historical skills required to engage with history as a discipline. Through the historical inquiry process, students question, analyse, interpret, explain and communicate their understanding of the past. The historical inquiry process involves students going through the steps of acquiring, processing and communicating in order to demonstrate their application of substantive and conceptual historical understanding.

Teaching and learning activities in Investigating ancient history should be designed to support students to make evidence-based arguments exploring historical concepts such as causation, significance, and continuity and change. For example, activities which compare and contrast a range of historical sources about an event will support students to engage with these concepts and to develop source-analysis skills. This in turn will encourage more rigorous interpretations. Selecting sources from a wide range of perspectives will develop students' knowledge base, which will ensure a stronger foundation for analysis and interpretation throughout the focus area.

To illustrate the content of the selected option(s) teachers may choose to use examples from the list below, develop their own investigations, or integrate their study with content from Case studies or an option from the focus area of Features of ancient societies. The following examples are suggestions only.

The investigation of ancient sites and sources

- The Theban Mapping Project
- Marine archaeology
- The Piltdown man
- Priam's treasure
- The Dead Sea Scrolls
- Homer's *Iliad*
- Selected excerpts from Herodotus or Thucydides
- Petra
- The Nazca Lines
- Lord of Sipán
- Plain of Jars

The representation of the ancient past

- Ramesses II
- Leonidas I
- Hannibal
- Zenobia
- The Battle of the Teutoburg Forest
- Babylon
- The Persians
- The Celts
- The Amazons

Conservation and reconstruction of ancient sites

- Giza
- Knossos

- The Athenian Agora
- Persepolis
- Palmyra
- Teotihuacan
- The site of the Terracotta Warriors in Xi'an
- A recent example of a site at risk

Cultural heritage and the role of museums

- The bust of Nefertiti
- Parthenon sculptures
- Crowther's collection
- Priam's treasure
- The Benin Bronzes
- Indigenous collections

The treatment and display of human remains

- Ötzi (the Iceman)
- Bog bodies
- The Tarim mummies
- Mummified remains of ancient Egypt
- Mungo Man and/or Mungo Woman

The focus areas in Year 11 may be integrated to suit the needs of students. For example:

- An option from the focus area The nature of ancient history can be integrated into Case studies or into the focus area Features of ancient societies. For example, content from The investigation of ancient sites and sources might be integrated with content from the case study on Troy. Alternatively, content from The representation of the ancient past might be integrated with content from Features of ancient societies – for instance, examining representations of ancient Greek women in modern media.
- Teachers may also select individual content points from several options in The nature of ancient history and teach these as a standalone option or integrate with Case studies or Features of ancient societies.

Teaching advice documents

- [Teaching advice \(additional\): Accessible sources in History 7–12](#)

Teaching advice for Features of ancient societies

Content

- Features of ancient societies

Teaching advice

This focus area provides opportunities for students to consider the causes and effects of developments, the role and significance of events, individuals and groups, continuity and change, and different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context.

The thematic approach allows for the application of historical understanding and skills to key feature(s) across 2 ancient societies. Students develop targeted historical skills including the analysis and use of sources, historical interpretation, explanation and communication. Using the discipline-based process of historical inquiry, students analyse sources for evidence, which they then use to develop claims about the past, considering key concepts such as continuity and change, and significance. Using these reasoned claims, students explain and communicate their understanding through historical accounts and arguments.

Designing teaching and learning

Integrating historical concepts and skills

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Use of sources

Sources are the key to any inquiry into the past and form the basis for historical analysis and interpretation. Using sources, students engage with a variety of perspectives as evidence to inform their understanding of the past. When selecting sources for teaching and learning activities, teachers should use and model ethical practices, such as the consideration of copyright and intellectual property acknowledgement, heritage issues, and Indigenous Cultural and Intellectual Property (ICIP) concerns, to ensure students understand the importance of engaging appropriately when using historical source material. Select source material carefully to cater for the needs of the students in the class, considering accessibility needs and issues such as the availability of audio and/or closed captions with videos, and of other materials such as tactile objects and replicas of maps and artefacts.

Historical inquiry

Historical inquiry is an active process that allows students to develop and enact the historical skills required to engage with history as a discipline. Through the historical inquiry process, students question, analyse, interpret, explain and communicate their understanding of the past. The historical inquiry process involves students going through the steps of acquiring, processing and communicating in order to demonstrate their application of substantive and conceptual historical understanding.

Teaching and learning activities in Features of ancient societies should be designed to support students to make evidence-based arguments exploring historical concepts such as causation, significance, and continuity and change. For example, activities which compare and contrast a

range of historical sources about an event will support students to engage with these concepts and to develop source-analysis skills. This in turn will encourage more rigorous interpretations. Selecting sources from a wide range of perspectives will develop students' knowledge base, which will ensure a stronger foundation for analysis and interpretation throughout the focus area.

This focus area can be sequenced as one unit or staged throughout the course. Teachers may choose to compare one key feature across 2 distinct societies or choose 2 distinct key features.

Teaching advice documents

- [Teaching advice \(additional\): Accessible sources in History 7–12](#)

Teaching advice for Core study: Cities of Vesuvius – Pompeii and Herculaneum

Content

- Core study: Cities of Vesuvius – Pompeii and Herculaneum

Teaching advice

Students develop targeted historical skills including the analysis and use of sources, historical interpretation, explanation and communication. Using the discipline-based process of historical inquiry, students analyse sources for evidence, which they then use to develop claims about the past, considering key concepts such as perspectives and contestability. Using these reasoned claims, students explain and communicate their understanding through historical accounts and arguments.

Teachers should provide a range of different types of both primary and secondary sources, so that students can apply and further develop the source-analysis skills learnt in Year 11. Providing a range of sources of varied complexity allows all students, including those with diverse learning needs, to engage in the process of analysis and historical inquiry.

Designing teaching and learning

Integrating historical concepts and skills

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Use of sources

Sources are the key to any inquiry into the past and form the basis for historical analysis and interpretation. Using sources, students engage with a variety of perspectives as evidence to inform their understanding of the past. When selecting sources for teaching and learning activities, teachers should use and model ethical practices, such as the consideration of copyright and intellectual property acknowledgement, heritage issues, and Indigenous Cultural and Intellectual Property (ICIP) concerns, to ensure students understand the importance of engaging appropriately when using historical source material. Select source material carefully to cater for the needs of the students in the class, considering accessibility needs and issues such as the availability of audio and/or closed captions with videos, and of other materials such as tactile objects and replicas of maps and artefacts.

Historical inquiry

Historical inquiry is an active process that allows students to develop and enact the historical skills required to engage with history as a discipline. Through the historical inquiry process, students question, analyse, interpret, explain and communicate their understanding of the past. The historical inquiry process involves students going through the steps of acquiring, processing and communicating in order to demonstrate their application of substantive and conceptual historical understanding.

Teaching and learning activities in Cities of Vesuvius – Pompeii and Herculaneum should be designed to support students to make evidence-based arguments exploring historical concepts such as causation, significance, and continuity and change. For example, activities which compare and contrast a range of historical sources about an event will support students to engage with these concepts and to develop source-analysis skills. This in turn will encourage more rigorous interpretations. Selecting sources from a wide range of perspectives will develop students' knowledge base, which will ensure a stronger foundation for analysis and interpretation throughout the focus area.

The Context content group provides information needed for students to understand the Core study and can be taught as a standalone point or integrated with relevant content. For example, the content point 'The geographical setting and natural features of Campania' supports student understanding of content points relating to economic activities and health. The 'Impact of the eruption of 79 CE on Pompeii and Herculaneum' content point can be related to 'The nature, range, value and limitations of sources about Pompeii and Herculaneum, including art, buildings, organic remains and writing', as well as content points in the Archaeology at Pompeii and Herculaneum content group.

Content in the Core study can be integrated. For example, 'The practices and challenges of excavation and conservation at the sites in the 20th and 21st centuries' may be taught concurrently with some content in '21st-century archaeological issues', where the selected practices overlap with contemporary issues, such as the destructive nature of excavation or the historical accuracy of reconstructions.

Teachers should identify a range of types of sources, as well as *specific* sources, from which students can draw evidence to support their explanations or arguments. Some sources will provide evidence which is relevant to more than one content point. For example, teachers may choose to explore the Villa of the Mysteries, which provides evidence related to women, industries, the features and functions of houses and the role of religion.

The content point 'The nature, range, value and limitations of sources about life in Pompeii and Herculaneum, including art, buildings, organic remains and writing' can be taught as a standalone point, or integrated with other content points in the Source analysis content group. Limitations of sources could include the number of sources, loss of provenance, the purpose of the source (such as graffiti or inscriptions) or the broader challenge of using archaeological sources to reconstruct life in Pompeii and Herculaneum. Historiographical issues may also be relevant in the analysis of sources.

Teaching advice documents

- [Teaching advice \(additional\): Accessible sources in History 7–12](#)

Teaching advice for Ancient societies

Content

- Ancient societies

Teaching advice

Students develop targeted historical skills including the analysis and use of sources, historical interpretation, explanation and communication. Using the discipline-based process of historical inquiry, students analyse sources for evidence, which they then use to develop claims about the past, considering key concepts such as perspectives and contestability. Using these reasoned claims, students explain and communicate their understanding through historical accounts and arguments.

Designing teaching and learning

Integrating historical concepts and skills

Historical concepts provide the framework through which students develop their understanding of the complexities of the past and the way it has been interpreted through time. They allow students to engage with historical thinking and form their own increasingly perceptive interpretations of historical events and forces. Teachers select the appropriate concepts on which to focus that align closely with their chosen content options. Some concepts will lend themselves more readily to specific options than others.

Use of sources

Sources are the key to any inquiry into the past and form the basis for historical analysis and interpretation. Using sources, students engage with a variety of perspectives as evidence to inform their understanding of the past. When selecting sources for teaching and learning activities, teachers should use and model ethical practices, such as the consideration of copyright and intellectual property acknowledgement, heritage issues, and Indigenous Cultural and Intellectual Property (ICIP) concerns, to ensure students understand the importance of engaging appropriately when using historical source material. Select source material carefully to cater for the needs of the students in the class, considering accessibility needs and issues such as the availability of audio and/or closed captions with videos, and of other materials such as tactile objects and replicas of maps and artefacts.

Historical inquiry

Historical inquiry is an active process that allows students to develop and enact the historical skills required to engage with history as a discipline. Through the historical inquiry process, students question, analyse, interpret, explain and communicate their understanding of the past. The historical inquiry process involves students going through the steps of acquiring, processing and communicating in order to demonstrate their application of substantive and conceptual historical understanding.

Teaching and learning activities in Ancient societies should be designed to support students to make evidence-based arguments exploring historical concepts such as causation, significance, and continuity and change. For example, activities which compare and contrast a range of historical sources about an event will support students to engage with these concepts and to develop source-analysis skills. This in turn will encourage more rigorous interpretations. Selecting sources from a wide range of perspectives will develop students' knowledge base, which will ensure a stronger foundation for analysis and interpretation throughout the focus area.

Some content may be integrated. The Context content group establishes the relevant background information needed to understand and interpret the content in this focus area. For example, in Context students identify 'The nature and range of sources for this period'. In Evaluation students learn about the issues of these sources in understanding the society. These content points could be taught separately, concurrently or integrated into other relevant content points in the focus area.

There is scope for further integration of content when teaching the content point 'Differing modern interpretations of a feature of this society'. This content may be relevant to several other content points. Teachers could identify the feature that best presents an example of differing modern interpretations and integrate this with the relevant content point(s).

Teaching advice documents

- [Teaching advice \(additional\): Accessible sources in History 7–12](#)

Teaching advice for Historical personalities

Content

- Historical personalities

Teaching advice

Students develop targeted historical skills including the analysis and use of sources, historical interpretation, explanation and communication. Using the discipline-based process of historical inquiry, students analyse sources for evidence, which they then use to develop claims about the past, considering key concepts such as perspectives and contestability. Using these reasoned claims, students explain and communicate their understanding through historical accounts and arguments.

Designing teaching and learning

Integrating historical concepts and skills

Historical concepts provide the framework through which students develop their understanding of the complexities of the past and the way it has been interpreted through time. They allow students to engage with historical thinking and form their own increasingly perceptive interpretations of historical events and forces. Teachers select the appropriate concepts on which to focus that align closely with their chosen content options. Some concepts will lend themselves more readily to specific options than others.

Use of sources

Sources are the key to any inquiry into the past and form the basis for historical analysis and interpretation. Using sources, students engage with a variety of perspectives as evidence to inform their understanding of the past. When selecting sources for teaching and learning activities, teachers should use and model ethical practices, such as the consideration of copyright and intellectual property acknowledgement, heritage issues, and Indigenous Cultural and Intellectual Property (ICIP) concerns, to ensure students understand the importance of engaging appropriately when using historical source material. Select source material carefully to cater for the needs of the students in the class, considering accessibility needs and issues such as the availability of audio and/or closed captions with videos, and of other materials such as tactile objects and replicas of maps and artefacts.

Historical inquiry

Historical inquiry is an active process that allows students to develop and enact the historical skills required to engage with history as a discipline. Through the historical inquiry process, students question, analyse, interpret, explain and communicate their understanding of the past. The historical inquiry process involves students going through the steps of acquiring, processing and communicating in order to demonstrate their application of substantive and conceptual historical understanding.

Teaching and learning activities in Historical personalities should be designed to support students to make evidence-based arguments exploring historical concepts such as causation, significance, and continuity and change. For example, activities which compare and contrast a range of historical sources about an event will support students to engage with these concepts and to develop source-analysis skills. This in turn will encourage more rigorous interpretations. Selecting sources from a wide range of perspectives will develop students' knowledge base, which will ensure a stronger foundation for analysis and interpretation throughout the focus area.

Some content may be integrated. The Context content group establishes the relevant background information needed to understand and interpret the content in the focus area. The content in Background and Key features and developments is generally sequenced chronologically. Teachers may choose to address the content in the Evaluation content group either at the end of or throughout the study. For example, evaluating the impact and influence of the personality could be an activity connected to each of the content points in the Key features and developments content group, or left to the end as the summation of the study.

Teaching advice documents

- [Teaching advice \(additional\): Accessible sources in History 7–12](#)

Glossary

Aboriginal Languages K–10 (2022) Terms

access content points

Content for students with significant intellectual disability who are working towards the Early Stage 1 outcomes. Teachers can use the access content points on their own, or in combination with the content for each outcome.

collaborate

Working with others towards a shared goal, through a variety of modes of communication. This may be achieved using a range of technologies, tools and processes.

colonisation

A process by which a different system of government is established by one nation over another group of Peoples. It involves the colonial power asserting and enforcing its sovereignty or right to govern according to its own laws rather than by laws of the colonised.

Community(ies)

Community(ies) is about interrelatedness and is central to shared conceptions of belonging. Aboriginal Peoples may belong to more than one Community. Important elements of Community are identification with Country or location, family ties and shared experience.

See [local Aboriginal community](#)

compare

Show how things are similar or different.

consultation

The involvement of representatives from the relevant Aboriginal Community(ies) in the planning, appropriate implementation and assessment of the syllabus. To pursue the idea of teaching an Aboriginal Language, a wide range of local Aboriginal organisations should be approached in person. To ensure that all owners and Custodians are reached, the consultation process should be ongoing and will take time.

context

An environment or situation (social, cultural or historical) in which a text is responded to or created. Or wording surrounding an unfamiliar word, which a reader or listener uses to understand its meaning.

conventions

Accepted practices or features that help define textual forms, creative forms, styles and meaning.

critically analyse/evaluate

Add a degree or level of accuracy, depth, knowledge and understanding, logic, questioning, reflection and quality to (analyse/evaluate).

Customary

Relating to customs or practices associated with a particular culture, society, place or set of circumstances. Similar to the term 'traditional', 'Customary' is used in reference to aspects of Aboriginal Cultures in pre-invasion contexts.

See [traditional](#)

ecology

In a languages context, ecology is used to describe the view that languages can be studied as living entities that are interrelated and that relate to their environments.

evaluate

Make a judgement based on criteria; determine the value of.

genre

The categories into which texts are grouped based on similarities in premise, structure and function. The 'genre' of a text describes larger recurring patterns of subject matter and textual structures observable between texts, such as typical plots, characters and setting.

'Genre' can also describe categories of form and structure in texts.

handshape

The held position of the hand and fingers in producing a particular sign.

identity

A person's conception and expression of individuality or group affiliation, self-concept and self-representation. It is closely connected to culture and language.

interpret

The act of translation from one language to another, the process of understanding and explaining.

intonation

The pattern or melody of pitch changes in connected speech, especially the pitch pattern of a sentence.

language awareness

A type of language program that develops an understanding of the forms of a language rather than the capacity to use it to communicate. For Aboriginal Languages, this program typically occurs in locations where historical language loss is extreme and few tangible records have survived.

language maintenance

Situation where a speaker, group of speakers or community of speakers continue to use their language despite competition with a dominant or majority language.

language reclamation

The process of restoring, preserving, recording and promoting Aboriginal Languages.

language renewal

A type of language program in which the target language is known and used by a community in part rather than in its entirety or 'right through'.

language revitalisation

A type of language program in which the goal is to encourage younger speakers to use the target language as fluently as older speakers.

linguistic

Relating to the systematic study of language.

metalanguage

Technical terms used to describe and discuss how language and texts function.

morpheme

The smallest unit of meaning in a word, e.g. jumps has 2 morphemes: jump + s.

nonverbal communication

Manually coded forms of communication in which the body is manipulated to convey meaning. These are often used in place of spoken languages. For Aboriginal Peoples nonverbal communication exists alongside spoken language(s) and are usually associated with particular Cultural protocols, e.g. relationships, ceremony, local Community.

observe/observing

To see, watch, perceive or notice. Observations can be made using all 5 senses as well as digital and non-digital tools that extend our senses.

perspective

A way of regarding situations, facts and texts, and evaluating their relative significance.

phoneme

The smallest unit of speech sound.

Examples include:

- Cat has 3 phonemes: c/a/t
- Truck has 4 phonemes: t/r/u/ck.

phonology

The study of the sound system of a language, especially regarding speech sounds such as phonemes.

principles

The guiding requirements and obligations of right conduct.

recount

Retell a series of events.

rhotics

Pronouncing the letters r, rr, rl when they occur after a vowel or at the end of a syllable.

scaffold

A framework to support the production of original text.

stakeholder

A person, group or organisation that has interest or concern.

See [custodians](#) and [consultation](#)

strengthening (of languages)

Improving the status and recognition of Aboriginal Languages, including the allocation of funding and resources, raising the prestige of the target language and the development of new words, where applicable.

symbols

The written representations of a language such as letters, characters, marks, accents; identifiable aspects of culture such as flags, artefacts, costumes, landmarks.

synthesise

Put together various elements to make a whole.

target language

The Aboriginal Language in which it is intended that a student will gain proficiency.

traditional

A term widely used to refer to pre-invasion Aboriginal life, Culture and social organisation, or the continuation of aspects of Aboriginal Cultures. The term 'traditional' must be used with care, as individuals and groups may find this term offensive. The word 'Customary' is often used to convey a similar message.

See [Customary](#)

view/viewing

Observing and comprehending a visual text, e.g. diagram, illustration, photograph, film, television documentary, multimedia. This sometimes involves listening to and reading accompanying written text.

Ancient History 11–12 (2024) Terms

ancient

In the study of Ancient History in Stage 6, the ancient period covers history from the development of early human communities to the end of late antiquity (around AD 650).

causation

A process that includes a range of possible reasons for an historical event, situation or development.

chronology

The order in which a series of events happened, or a list of these events in the order in which they happened.

colonisation

In Modern History – a process by which a different system of government is established by one nation over another group of peoples. It involves the colonial power asserting and enforcing its sovereignty or right to govern according to its own laws rather than by laws of the colonised.

In Ancient History – a process by which ancient societies establish settlements in other lands and establish trading connections.

concepts

The key ideas that shape the practice of the discipline of history, e.g. causation, continuity and change, contestability, perspectives and significance. They provide the scope for judgement, interpretation and argument and are the major means by which knowledge is constructed, analysed, questioned and represented.

contestability

An examination of how interpretations and representations of the past differ, e.g. as a result of using differing evidence or resulting from different perspectives.

continuity and change

Aspects of the past that have remained the same over a period of time or have changed over time. Change can be understood as a 'process'.

dispossession

The removal of people from their lands which had been occupied and cared for by their ancestors over thousands of years.

evidence

The information elicited and interpreted from a source that is used to support arguments or inform a specific inquiry.

heritage

Tangible or intangible aspects of the past that are valued by an individual, group, community or nation as a result of birth, inheritance or membership. It can also be applied to significant examples of the human or natural environment.

historical authentication

A process of verifying the origins of an artefact or object and establishing it as genuine.

historical inquiry

The process of developing knowledge and understanding by posing questions about the past, and applying skills associated with locating, analysing, evaluating and using sources as evidence to develop an informed argument or interpretation.

historiography

The study of how history is constructed. It involves the critical analysis and evaluation of historical methodologies and the way history has been written over time.

ideology

A framework of beliefs that guides actions, e.g. fascism and communism.

interpretation

A way of understanding and explaining what has happened in the past. The discipline of History acknowledges that there is often more than one view of what happened in the past.

modern

In the study of Modern History in Stage 6, the period of time in the modern world – generally between 1750 and the present.

perspective

A point of view from which historical events, problems and issues can be analysed, e.g. the perspective of an individual or group in the past. This may involve empathetic understanding – the capacity to enter into the world of the past from the point of view of a particular individual or group from that time, including an appreciation of the circumstances they faced, and the motivations, values and attitudes behind their actions.

reconstruction

A process of piecing together evidence from sources to develop an understanding or picture of the past. It may include the physical reconstruction of ancient sites.

reliability

Consideration of the context, purpose, origin and audience of a source to determine how accurately an area of historical study is represented. A source is neither reliable nor unreliable in and of itself. It can only be judged reliable or useful for the question that is asked. Reliability requires an understanding of perspective.

representation

A portrayal of the past that may reflect a popular view within society, past or present, or that may be constructed by historians.

significance

The importance attributed to a particular aspect of the past such as an individual or event. Significance involves an understanding of the various considerations which cause different groups at different times to judge aspects of the past more or less historically significant.

source

Any written or non-written materials that can be used to investigate the past.

Extended in 7–12 History Syllabuses: A source is used to elicit 'evidence' in order to answer a specific historical question, inform a historical inquiry, or to support or refute an interpretation.

terms

A word or phrase used to describe abstract aspects or features of the past, e.g. imperialism, democracy or republic; and more specific features, such as trench warfare, or a dictator, gladiator or vizier.

terra nullius

A concept in international law meaning 'a territory belonging to no-one' or 'over which no-one claims ownership'.

Global Terms

Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples

Aboriginal Peoples are the Traditional custodians of Australia and are represented by more than 250 language groups, each connected with a particular Country. Torres Strait Islander Peoples are represented by 5 major island groups and are connected with islands to the north of Australia's Cape York which were annexed by Queensland in 1879.

An Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander person is someone who:

- is of Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander descent
- identifies as an Aboriginal person and/or Torres Strait Islander person, and
- is accepted as such by the Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander Community(ies) in which they live.

Aboriginal English

A recognised dialect of English which is the first, or home language, of many Aboriginal people. It differs from other dialects of English, such as Standard Australian English, in systematic ways including sounds, grammar, words and their meanings, and language use. Aboriginal English is a powerful vehicle for the expression of Aboriginal identity. Aboriginal English is not a target language study option for NSW Aboriginal Languages syllabuses.

Aboriginal Songline(s)

Texts that describe landscapes and directions of the tracks forged in lands, waters and skies by Creator Spirits during the Dreaming.

accessibility

The extent to which a system, environment or object may be used irrespective of a user's capabilities or abilities. For example, the use of assistive technologies (AT) to allow people with disability to use computer systems, or the use of icons in place of words to allow young children to use a system.

assistive technology (AT)

A device or system whose primary purpose is to maintain or improve an individual's functioning and independence to facilitate participation and enhance overall wellbeing. This includes technologies specifically designed to meet an individual's needs, eg eye gaze technology, as well as more general technologies that can be used by anyone, eg speech-to-text applications. Assistive technology can also be referred to as inclusive technology.

augmentative and alternative communication (AAC)

An umbrella term that encompasses the communication methods used to supplement or replace speech or writing. AAC can be unaided, such as gestures, body language and sign language, or aided such as pictures, symbols, objects or speech generating devices.

See [communication systems](#)

communication forms

The ways people communicate and the communicative behaviours they use. Communication forms can be non-symbolic and/or symbolic. Non-symbolic forms include sounds, gestures, facial expressions and eye movements. Symbolic forms can be aided or non-aided. Aided forms of symbolic communication include objects, symbols, photographs and drawings. Aided forms can be

digital. Non-aided forms of symbolic communication include formal gestures; speech; and signs, such as Key Word Sign.

copyright

The protection provided to the creators of original works and makers of sound recordings and films, that offers a legal framework for the control and reproduction or transmission of their literary, dramatic, artistic or musical works.

Country/Place

Country is used to describe a specific area of a nation or clan including physical, linguistic and spiritual features. Aboriginal communities' cultural associations with their Country may include or relate to languages, cultural practices, knowledge, songs, stories, art, paths, landforms, flora, fauna and minerals. These cultural associations may include custodial relationships with particular landscapes such as land, sea, sky, rivers as well as the intangible places associated with the Dreaming(s). Custodial relationships are extremely important in determining who may have the capacity to authentically speak for their Country.

Place is a space mapped out by physical or intangible boundaries that individuals or groups of Torres Strait Islander Peoples occupy and regard as their own. It is a space with varying degrees of spirituality.

culture

The customs, habits, beliefs/spirituality, social organisation and ways of life that characterise different groups and communities. Cultural characteristics give a group or individual a sense of who they are and help them make sense of the world in which they live. Culture is a shared system but inherently diverse – there can be individual and group differences within cultures. Everyone has culture – it is a lens through which we see the world.

custodians

In Aboriginal communities, an individual charged with maintaining and passing on particular elements of cultural significance, eg language, stories, songs, rituals and imagery.

d/Deaf

When referring to deaf people who belong to a linguistic and cultural minority known as the Deaf community, the 'D' may be capitalised in reference to the individual, the group, or the culture in order to accord respect and deference, for example, the Deaf community. When referring simply to audiological status or when cultural affiliation is not known, as in the case of a person with a hearing loss in general, the lowercase 'd', as in 'deaf' is the more common usage.

Deaf

A cultural identity for people with hearing loss who share a common culture and who usually have a shared sign language.

disability

An umbrella term for any or all of the following components:

- impairments: challenges in body function or structure
- activity limitations: difficulties in executing activities
- participation restrictions: challenges an individual may experience in involvement in life situations. (World Health Organization)

diversity

Differences that exist within a group, for example, age, sex, gender, gender expression, sexuality, ethnicity, ability/disability, body shape and composition, culture, religion/spirituality, learning differences, socioeconomic background, values and experiences.

Dreaming

The Dreaming has different meanings for different Aboriginal groups. The Dreaming can be seen as the embodiment of Aboriginal creation which gives meaning to everything; the essence of Aboriginal beliefs about creation and spiritual and physical existence. It establishes the rules governing relationships between the people, the land and all things for Aboriginal Peoples. The Dreaming is linked to the past, the present and the future. Where appropriate, refer to Aboriginal names for the Dreaming.

Elders

The custodians of knowledge and lore. They are chosen and accepted by their own communities as people who have the permission to disclose cultural knowledge and beliefs. Recognised Elders are highly respected people within Aboriginal communities. Proper consultation with local Aboriginal communities will often direct schools to recognised Elders.

first language(s)

The first language(s) that a person learns to speak.

Indigenous

An internationally recognised term for the first peoples of a land. In NSW the term Aboriginal person/Peoples is preferred.

See [Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples](#)

Indigenous cultural and intellectual property (ICIP)

Includes, but is not limited to, objects, sites, cultural knowledge, cultural expression and the arts, that have been transmitted or continue to be transmitted through generations as belonging to a particular Indigenous group or Indigenous people as a whole or their territory.

See [intellectual property](#)

intellectual property

Non-material assets such as forms of cultural expression that belong to a particular individual or community. Intellectual property rights refer to the rights that the law grants to individuals for the protection of creative, intellectual, scientific and industrial activity, such as inventions.

See [Indigenous cultural and intellectual property \(ICIP\)](#), and [copyright](#)

Key Word Sign

A communication strategy that incorporates signing with speech. It is used to support language development for people with communication difficulties. Although Key Word Sign uses a simplified form of manual signing, it is different to Auslan, as it is not a signed language.

kinship

A key aspect of Aboriginal cultures and values. It includes the importance of all relationships and of being related to and belonging to the land.

language group

An Aboriginal community identified with a common language, both verbal and nonverbal, and with a particular territory. Used in preference to the term 'tribe'.

language revival

The process and range of strategies for increasing knowledge and use of a language that is no longer spoken fluently across all generations in the context of language loss or language dispossession caused by colonisation. Aboriginal Languages and Torres Strait Islander Languages are being revived through community initiatives, linguistic research and school programs. 'Language revival' may be used as an overarching term that could also include 'reclamation', 'revitalisation', 'renewal' and 'reawakening'.

local Aboriginal community

A local Aboriginal community is constituted by those people who are Aboriginal and who reside in the near locality. Aboriginal communities will have a rich and diverse history that has been seriously affected by dispossession and relations, which sees families with spiritual connection to Country residing beside those who have been forced to move from other locations. The notion of locality is complex and multilayered: schools should seek advice from a range of people and/or organisations representing local interests.

See [community\(ies\)](#)

off-Country

Taking place away from Aboriginal land or Country of origin.

See [Country/Place](#)

on-Country

Taking place on Aboriginal land or Country of origin.

See [Country/Place](#)

protocols

The appropriate ways of behaving, communicating and showing respect for diversity of history and culture. This involves appreciation of the knowledge, standing and status of people within the local Aboriginal community and the school community. Protocols inevitably vary between communities, and between people within a community. In establishing a partnership between schools and Aboriginal communities, it is especially important that protocols are acknowledged and respected.

sign

Hand signs (or hand talk) used to supplement or replace oral language. Signs form part of nonverbal communication for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples and may be used by people who are hearing, or d/Deaf or hard of hearing. Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Sign Languages may be used in some areas. Some Sign Languages may be associated with sacred ceremonial practices.

signage

The use of words, graphic designs and/or symbols used to communicate a message, eg information signs, plaques, warning signs, road signs, signs that show direction.

switch

A type of assistive technology that enables people with cognitive and/or physical disability to access a range of devices, including computers and communication devices. Switches can be activated by touch, or triggered without contact, such as through eye gaze, sound or blowing.

See [assistive technology \(AT\)](#)

yarning circle

Yarning circles are an important cultural practice for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples to learn within the collective group. Knowledge and information are shared in harmony and respect with all individuals.